SOC401 Glossary

- **Acculturation**

The process by which a culture is transformed due to the massive adoption of cultural traits from another society--it is what happens to a culture when alien traits diffuse in on a large scale and substantially replace traditional cultural patterns.

- **Achieved status**

a status that is acquired by doing something. For instance, someone acquires a criminal status by committing a crime. Likewise, the status of mother is attained by having a baby.

- **Actual behavior**

What people really do in their lives rather than what they think they are doing or what they believe they should be doing. In most societies there is a discrepancy between these three kinds of behavior. It is important for anthropologists to distinguish between actual, believed, and ideal behavior when they learn about another society and its culture.

- **Adaptive mechanism**

A behavior, strategy, or technique for obtaining food and surviving in a particular environment. Successful adaptive mechanisms provide a selective advantage in the competition for survival with other life forms. For humans, the most important adaptive mechanism is culture

- **Affinity**

A kinship link created by marriage, such as the bond between a man and his wife and her family (in-laws). People who have an affinity relationship with each other are "affine"

- **Affirmative action**

A program or policy intended to correct the effects of past discrimination in employment, education, housing, etc. Usually affirmative action in the United States includes out-reach programs, hiring goals, set-asides, and/or extra opportunities for members of underrepresented minorities.

- **Age grades**

Age-based categories of people recognized by a culture. In North America, for example, we generally label people as children, teenagers, adults, middle aged, and elderly or senior citizens.

❖ **Age sets**

Age grades that are clearly recognized in a culture as distinct identifiable groups of people. They consist of people of similar age and usually of the same gender who share a common identity and maintain close ties throughout their lives. They also pass through age-related statuses together as a group. The transition between these statuses is usually marked by a rite of passage.

❖ **Ambilineal descent**

A form of cognatic descent in which individuals can select to trace descent either matrilineally or patrilineally. The decision may be made each generation based on the relative wealth and/or importance of the father's and the mother's family lines.

❖ **Ambilocal Residence**

The residence pattern in which a newly married couple has the choice of living with or near the groom's or the bride's family.

❖ **Anomie**

A feeling of alienation and isolation from all other people, including family and friends.

❖ **Anthropology**

The broad scientific study of human culture and biology. Anthropologists are interested in what it is to be human in all of our many different societies around the world today and in the past.

❖ **Applied anthropology**

The branch of anthropology oriented towards using anthropological knowledge for practical purposes.

❖ **Aquatic Foraging**

A specialized subsistence pattern that concentrates on fish and/or marine mammal hunting. Aquatic foraging is usually a far more reliable and productive strategy for obtaining food than the diversified hunting and gathering of most foragers who live away from the coasts and major rivers.

❖ **Archaeology**

The systematic study of the material remains of human behavior in the past. Archaeologists reconstruct the prehistory and early history of societies and their cultures through an examination and interpretation of such things as house foundations, broken tools, and food refuse.

❖ **Arranged marriage**

A marriage partner selection process in which the future bride and groom usually do not participate actively in the decision. Marriages are commonly arranged by parents or their agents.

❖ **Ascribed status**

A status that is the result of being born into a particular family or being born male or female.

❖ **Assimilation**

The absorption of an individual or minority group of people into another society or group. This is achieved by learning and adopting the cultural traditions of the society to which assimilation occurs.

❖ **Balanced Reciprocity**

An economic exchange in which there is an explicit expectation of immediate return. Simple barter or supermarket purchases involve this understanding.

❖ **Band**

The level of political integration in which a society consists only of an association of families living together. Bands are loosely allied by marriage, descent, friendship, and common interest.

❖ **Barter**

Trading goods and services directly for other goods and services without the use of money as a medium of exchange.

❖ **Bilateral Descent**

The cognatic pattern of descent in which every biological ancestor and descendant is a socially recognized relative.

❖ **Bilineal Descent**

The cognatic pattern of descent in which an individual is both a member of his mother's matrilineage and his father's patrilineage.

❖ **Bound morpheme**

A morpheme that has meaning but can not stand alone. The prefix dis in the English word dislike is an example.

❖ **Caste**

An individual's rigidly ascribed, or inherited, status within society.

❖ **Chiefdom**

The level of political integration in which a society has a more or less permanent political leader (i.e., a chief) but no bureaucracy of professional administrators.

❖ **Clan**

A group of people who claim unilineal descent from the same ancestor but who cannot specify all of the actual links. Clans usually consist of a number of related unilineages.

❖ **Class**

A group of people thought of as a unit because they are similar in terms of social and/or economic factors.

❖ **Cognatic Descent**

Tracing kinship through both the mother's and the father's ancestors to some degree. Cognatic descent occurs in three forms: ambilineal, bilineal, parallel, and bilateral descent.

❖ **Colonial powers**

A term referring mostly to the Western European nations that carved out colonies in Africa, Asia, Central and South America, and the Pacific during the 18th through the early 20th centuries. The U.S., Russia, and Japan also acquired colonial empires in the late 19th and early 20th centuries.

❖ **Commerce**

Large-scale buying and selling of goods and services within and between societies that usually have market economies.

❖ **Common law**

A law that has evolved over time and is part of the cultural tradition rather than being created by enactment in legislatures or by rulers.

❖ **Consanguinity**

A socially recognized biological descent link, such as between a woman and her father, aunt, or daughter. Individuals who have a consanguinity relationship to each other. Consanguinity literally means "with the blood".

❖ **Crime**

A deviation from the social norm that is of such magnitude as to go beyond what would be considered bad manners or odd behavior.

❖ **Cultural Anthropology**

The study of contemporary and recent historical cultures all over the world. The focus is on social organization, culture change, economic and political systems, and religion. Cultural anthropology is also referred to as social or sociocultural anthropology.

Cultural relativity

Suspending one's ethnocentric judgments in order to understand and appreciate another culture. Anthropologists try to learn about and interpret the various aspects of the culture they are studying in reference to that culture rather than to their own. This provides a better understanding of how such practices as polygamy and cannibalism can function and even support other cultural traditions.

❖ **Cultural universals**

Cultural traits that are shared by all of humanity collectively. Examples of such general traits are communicating with a verbal language, using age and gender to classify people, and raising children in some sort of family setting. No matter where people live in the world, they share these universal cultural traits.

❖ **Culture**

The full range of learned behavior patterns that are acquired by people as members of a society. A culture is a complex, largely interconnected whole that consists of the knowledge, belief, art, law, morals, customs, skills, and habits learned from parents and others in a society. Culture is the primary adaptive mechanism for humans.

❖ **Culture shock**

Feelings of confusion, distress, and sometimes depression that can result from the psychological stress caused by the strain of rapidly adjusting to an alien culture. This is usually compounded by feelings of homesickness. These feelings can be emotionally debilitating. However, culture shock eventually passes for most people.

❖ **Descent**

Socially recognized links between ancestors and descendants, such as the bond between children and their parents.

❖ **Developed Nation (or society)**

A nation or society that is relatively wealthy and usually industrialized. Most of the people in developed nations have adequate access to food, electricity, fossil fuels, education, and medicine with the consequence that their lives are materially more comfortable and their life spans are significantly longer than those in underdeveloped nations.

❖ **Dialect**

A variant of a language. If it is associated with a geographically isolated speech community, it is referred to as a regional dialect. However, if it is spoken by a speech community that is merely socially isolated, it is called a social dialect.

❖ **Diffusion**

The movement of cultural traits and ideas from one society or ethnic group to another

❖ **Diglossia**

The phenomenon in which different dialects of a language or different languages are spoken by a person in different social situations.

❖ **Discrimination**

The act of distinguishing differences between people and showing favoritism or prejudicial rejection of them.

- **Distribution and exchange (systems of)**

The practices that are involved in getting the goods and services produced by a society to its people.

- **Diversified foraging**

A hunting and gathering subsistence pattern in which there is not a concentration of efforts in harvesting a small number of species. Rather, virtually all potential food sources in the environment are exploited. Most pedestrian foragers take a diversified approach. In contrast, aquatic and equestrian foragers are specialized.

- **Division of labor**

Referring to the jobs that are normally assigned to people based on such things as gender and age. In most foraging societies, large animal hunting is an occupation of adult males, while domestic tasks, child rearing, and plant food collecting are mostly adult female jobs.

- **Egalitarian**

Referring to societies in which all people are equal in terms of economic and political rights. Foraging bands are the most egalitarian societies. However, even in these societies, there are differences based on age and sometimes gender.

- **Emic categories**

Referring to the categorization of things according to the way in which members of a society classify their own world.

- **Eminent domain**

The right of a government to take legal possession of private property for public use. In most Western countries, the property owner is financially compensated for the loss based on what is considered to be fair market value. An example of eminent domain is a government taking someone's house and land in order to build a road through the property.

- **Enculturation**

The process of being socialized to a particular culture. This includes learning the language, customs, biases, and values of the culture. Through enculturation an individual learns the statuses, roles, rules, and values of his or her own culture. The most intensive period of enculturation is usually during early childhood, but the process continues throughout life.

- **Endogamy**

A marriage partner selection rule requiring that marriage be to someone within a defined social group such as an extended family, religious community, economic class, ethnic or age group. Selection is always further restricted by exogamy rules.

❖ **Ethnic group**

A category or group of people considered to be significantly different from others in terms of cultural (dialect, religion, traditions, etc.) and sometimes physical characteristics (skin color, body shape, etc.).

❖ **Ethnic symbol**

Selected traits used as symbolic badges of identity to emphasize distinctness from other ethnic groups. Dialect, religion, and style of dress are common ethnic symbols. Biological characteristics, such as skin color and body shape, may be used as ethnic symbols as well.

❖ **Ethnicity**

Ethnic group identity.

❖ **Ethnocentrism**

The deep felt belief or feeling that your culture is superior to all others. Being fond of your own way of life and condescending or even hostile toward other cultures is normal for all people.

❖ **Ethnography**

Anthropological research in which one learns about the culture of another society through fieldwork and first hand observation in that society. Ethnography is also the term used to refer to books or monographs describing what were learned about the culture of a society.

❖ **Ethnology**

An anthropological study that systematically compares similar cultures. An example of an ethnological study would be a comparison of what cultures are like in societies that have economies based on hunting and gathering rather than agriculture.

❖ **Ethnoscience**

The field of anthropology that tries to learn about how people in different cultures categorize things in their environment. The focus is on emic categories. This data provides important insights into the interests, concerns, and values of cultures.

❖ **Etic categories**

Referring to the classification of things according to some external system of analysis brought in by a visitor to another society. This is the approach of biology in using the Linnaean classification system to define new species. It assumes that ultimately, there is an objective reality and that is more important than cultural perceptions of it.

❖ **Exogamy**

A marriage partner selection rule requiring that marriage is with someone outside of a defined social group such as one's nuclear family. Selection is usually further restricted by endogamy rules.

❖ **Extended family**

Two or more nuclear families tied together by bonds of descent. Usually an extended family contains living relatives from three or more generations.

❖ **Family of orientation**

See nuclear family.

❖ **Family of procreation**

See nuclear family.

❖ **Foragers**

People who live in more or less isolated, small societies and obtain their food by foraging wild plants and hunting wild animals. Foragers generally have a passive dependence on what the environment contains. They do not plant crops and the only domesticated animals that they usually have are dogs. Most foraging societies do not establish permanent settlements. Rather, they have relatively temporary encampments with tents or other easily constructed dwellings. The length of time that they stay in any one location is largely determined by the availability of resources. Foragers are also referred to as hunters and gatherers.

❖ **Generalized reciprocity**

Gift giving without the expectation of an immediate return. It is understood that at some time in the future there will be an appropriate repayment.

❖ **Genocide**

The act or attempt to systematically kill all members of an ethnic group or culture. The Nazi extermination of Jews and gypsies by the millions before and during World War II is an example of genocide.

❖ **Globalism**

The progressive emergence of a single worldwide economic system and the simultaneous reduction in global cultural and political differences. Those who advocate globalism generally believe that ethnocentrism, nationalism, and tribalism are obstacles that must be overcome.

❖ **Grammar**

The part of language analysis that is concerned with how the sounds are used to make sense. Grammar consists of morphology and syntax.

❖ **Hawaiian naming system**

A kin naming system in which relatives are distinguished only by generation and gender. This results in just 4 different kin terms of reference. Ego's father and all male relatives in his generation are referred to by the same kin term (1). Likewise, ego's mother and all female relatives in her

generation have the same kin term (2). All brothers and male cousins are linked by giving them the same kin term (3). Sisters and all female cousins are also referred to by the same term (4).

- **Heterogeneous society**

A society consisting of many different ethnic and/or "racial" groups, social classes, languages and/or dialects, and cultural traditions. The U.S. and Canada are heterogeneous societies.

- **Hierarchical society**

A society that is divided into unequal social classes and individual statuses. There commonly is a ranking of classes and statuses in hierarchical societies such that those that are at the top of the ranking have greater power and wealth. Large intensive agriculture based societies typically have a social and political pyramid with an elite ruling class at the top and the majority of the people at the bottom.

- **Homogenous society**

A society that predominantly or entirely consists of people who share the same ethnicity/race, language, and cultural traditions. Most small-scale societies are homogenous. A few large-scale ones, like Japan, are as well.

- **Horticulturalists**

People who obtain most of their food by low intensity farming. This subsistence pattern involves at least part time planting and tending of domesticated food plants. Pigs, chickens, or other relatively small domesticated animals are often raised for food and prestige. Many horticultural societies supplement their farming subsistence base with occasional hunting and gathering of wild plants and animals. Their societies are usually larger and more sedentary than those of foragers but still are at a low technological level and relatively small-scale.

- **Household**

A residential group usually, but not always, consisting of members of the same family.

- **Hunters and gatherers**

See foragers.

- **Hypothesis**

A tentative explanation for a set of observable or measurable facts that is tested using the scientific method.

- **Ideal behavior**

What people believe that they should do in their lives rather than what they think they are doing or what they actually are doing? In most societies there is a discrepancy between these three kinds of behavior. It is important for anthropologists to distinguish between actual, believed, and ideal behavior when they learn about another society and its culture. imitative magic

❖ **Indigenous**

Referring to the native population of an area.

❖ **Industrial Revolution**

The transition from a society primarily dependent on hand tools produced by individual craftsmen to one with machine and power tools developed through large-scale industrial production. In Western Cultures, this began to occur during the last half of the 18th century. It resulted in increased individual wealth, progressive urbanization, and globalization of the economy.

❖ **Intensive agriculture**

A subsistence pattern characterized by full-time farming in which large beasts of burden or highly mechanized farm equipment (e.g., rototillers and tractors) are used to prepare the land for planting and later to harvest crops. Intensive agriculture usually involves the use of irrigation or other forms of water management. Often there is mono-cropping with heavy applications of fertilizers, pesticides, and herbicides. This form of agriculture is highly productive but generally capital intensive.

❖ **Invention**

Something new that is created. Invented cultural traits may be new things or ideas. It is rare for inventions to be based on entirely new principles, functions, and forms. Most often, old principles are applied to new functions and/or forms.

❖ **Joint family**

Two or more relatives of the same generation living together with their respective spouses and children. Joint families typically consist of 1-2 generations. See extended family.

❖ **Kin naming system**

A culturally defined set of rules for terms of address and reference to be used for specific categories of relatives. There are 6 different kin naming systems in use around the world: Eskimo, Hawaiian, Sudanese, Omaha, Crow, and Iroquois. Kin naming systems are also referred to as "kin terminological systems."

❖ **Kindred**

A family group bound together by their kinship ties to one person. An individual's kindred consist of all of the people who are related to him or her through consanguinal ties and possibly affinal ones as well. That is, it includes one's biological relatives and sometimes spouses and in-laws.

❖ **Kinship**

Culturally defined relationships between individuals who are commonly thought of as having family ties. Kinship is based on marriage, descent.

❖ **Language**

A specific set of rules for generating speech.

❖ **Large-scale farming**

See intensive agriculture.

❖ **Large-scale society**

Generally, a society with cities, industry, intensive agriculture, and a complex international economy. Such societies have socio-economic classes and a government with hierarchies of officials. The importance of kinship is diminished in social, economic, and political matters (in comparison to small-scale societies).

❖ **Latent functions**

Functions that are less apparent and more difficult to uncover (e.g., building a bridge to keep workers employed and provide a recognizable symbol of a city). See manifest functions.

❖ **Law**

A society's rules of conduct that are usually based on social norms and generally recognized by its members as binding or enforceable.

❖ **Levels of political integration**

A term referring to general types of political systems used to organize and manage societies. As a society's population size and territory grow, it must develop new political solutions to keep from splitting apart. In the 1950's, the American Anthropologist, Elman Service described four levels of political integration that have have been used around the world to solve this problem--band, tribe, chiefdom, and state. While there are some unique cultural variations of each of these levels, they are remarkably similar from one society to another. Subsequently, classifying a society in terms of its level of political integration has proven to be a useful tool in comprehending the wide range of human cultures and societies from small foraging communities to modern nation states.

❖ **Linguistics**

The comparative study of the function, structure, and history of languages and the communication process in general. Linguistics is also referred to as linguistic anthropology.

❖ **Manifest functions**

Functions that are obvious and easily discovered even by strangers (e.g., building a bridge to get to quickly get across a narrow waterway).

❖ **Market economy**

an impersonal but highly efficient system of production, distribution, and exchange that is principally characterized by: 1) the use of money as a means of exchange, 2) having the ability to accumulate vast amounts of capital (i.e., wealth that can be used to fund further production), and

3) having highly complex economic interactions that are ultimately international in the scale of their inter-relatedness.

❖ **Marriage**

The socially recognized union of two or more people. It is a universal method of regulating heterosexual intercourse by defining who is acceptable as a sexual partner and who is not. Marriage establishes social relationships that are the foundation for families and households.

❖ **Matrilineage**

A multi-generational group of relatives who are related by matrilineal descent. Matrilineages usually consist of a number of related nuclear families descended from the same woman.

❖ **Matrilineal descent**

Unilineal descent that follows the female line. With this pattern, people are related if they can trace descent through females to the same female ancestor. Both males and females inherit membership in a matrilineal family line, but only females can pass it on to their descendants.

❖ **Matrilocal residence**

The residence pattern in which a newly married couple moves in with or near the bride's mother's house. This keeps women near their female relatives, while men must leave their natal households. Matrilocal residence is strongly associated with matrilineal descent.

❖ **Mechanized grain farming**

Intensive farming for the production of cereals (e.g., corn, wheat, oats) in which hundreds and even thousands of acres are planted, tended, and harvested by a small number of people using large machinery (e.g., tractors and combines). There usually are heavy applications of fertilizers, pesticides, and herbicides.

❖ **Metropolitan world-view**

A world-view in which people have an emotional detachment between people and the realms of nature and the supernatural. Animals, trees, rocks, and other things in nature are "its" rather than "thous" and do not have human personalities. This separation of people emotionally from nature allows them to exploit it with little care for its well being. When the characteristics of this type of world-view were first proposed in the early 1950's by Robert Redfield, it was called a "civilized world-view." See indigenous world-view.

❖ **Minority group**

An ethnic/racial group that has a smaller population than the controlling majority group in a society. Minority groups may also be based on shared gender, age, disabilities, political views, etc.

❖ **Moiety**

One of two unilineal divisions of an entire society. Moieties have reciprocal privileges and obligations with each other, such as providing marriage partners and assisting at funerals. The founding moiety ancestor is often so genealogically remote that he or she is now mythical. Societies with moieties usually consist of a few thousand people or less. Societies with phratries instead of moieties are often larger.

❖ **Money**

Anything that serves as a medium of exchange for buying and selling goods and services.

❖ **Monogamy**

Marriage of one woman to one man at a time. This is the most common marriage pattern around the world today. If remarriage is allowed following divorce or death of a spouse, the marriage pattern could be defined as being "serial monogamy."

❖ **Morpheme**

The smallest combination of sounds (i.e., phonemes) that have meaning and cannot be broken into smaller meaningful units. Words can be one or more morphemes. For example, hot is one morpheme while hotdog is composed of two (hot and dog).

❖ **Morphology**

The term in linguistics for the study of how sounds (i.e., phonemes) are combined by language into larger units called morphemes.

❖ **Multiculturalism**

A "salad bowl" model of society in which the permanent existence of unassimilated and partially assimilated ethnic/racial minorities is accepted and encouraged. Those who advocate this model for America generally advocate providing special attention and assistance to minorities that had been underrepresented in the past.

❖ **Nationalism**

Extreme loyalty and devotion to a nation and its interests, usually at the expense of other nations or societies.

❖ **Natolocal residence**

The residence pattern in which a bride and groom remain in their own separate family's households or compounds after their marriage rather than occupy a residence together. The children born of this union usually stay in their mother's home, which becomes a de facto matricentric residence.

❖ **Neolocal Residence**

The residence pattern in which a married couple establishes a new residence independent of both their relatives. This pattern is now common in North America and other industrialized nations in which the importance of kinship is minimized.

❖ **Norms**

The conceptions of appropriate and expected behavior that are held by most members of the society. Norms are also referred to as "social norms."

❖ **Nuclear family**

A family consisting of a man, woman, and their children. We are born into our "nuclear family of orientation" and we have children in our "nuclear family of procreation." Parents may think of themselves as being members of both of these families at the same time.

❖ **Parallel descent**

The cognatic pattern of descent in which males trace their descent through the male line of their father and females through the female line of their mother. Unlike bilineal descent, every individual is a member of only one unilineage.

❖ **Participant observation**

Physically and emotionally participating in the social interaction of another society on a daily basis in order to learn about its culture. In practice this usually requires living within the community as a member, learning their language, establishing close friendship ties, eating what they eat, and taking part in normal family activities. By becoming an active participant rather than simply an observer, ethnographers reduce the cultural distance between themselves and the host society.

❖ **Pastoral nomadism**

Traditional pastoralists who follow a seasonal migratory pattern that can vary from year to year. The timing and destinations of migrations are determined primarily by the needs of the herd animals for water and fodder. These nomadic societies do not create permanent settlements, but rather they live in tents or other relatively easily constructed dwellings the year round. Pastoralist nomads are usually self-sufficient in terms of food and most other necessities.

❖ **Pastoralists**

People who make their living by tending herds of large animals. The species of animals vary with the region of the world, but they are all domesticated herbivores that normally live in herds and eat grasses or other abundant plant foods (e.g., cattle, horses, sheep, reindeer). Traditional pastoralists are essentially subsistence herders who form small-scale societies. There are essentially two forms of pastoralism--nomadism and transhumance.

❖ **Patrilineage**

A multi-generational group of relatives who are related by patrilineal descent. Patrilineages usually consist of a number of related nuclear families descended from the same man.

❖ **Patrilineal descent**

unilineal descent that follows the male line. With this pattern, people are related if they can trace descent through males to the same male ancestor. Both males and females inherit a patrilineal

family membership but only males can pass it on to their descendants. Also known as "agnatic descent."

❖ **Patrilocal residence**

The residence pattern in which a newly married couple moves in with or near the groom's father's house. This keeps men near their male relatives, while women must leave their natal households. Patrilocal residence is strongly associated with patrilineal descent. Just over half of the world's societies have patrilocal residence.

❖ **Pedestrian foragers**

People whose subsistence pattern involves diversified hunting and gathering on foot rather than horseback. The pedestrian hunting and gathering way of life was mobile. Most of these societies moved their camps several times a year and had temporary dwellings. The number of people living in a camp also often varied throughout the year depending on the local food supply. (The word "pedestrian" is derived from the Latin word pedester meaning "on foot").

❖ **Personality**

All of an individual's complex of mental characteristics that makes him or her unique from other people. It includes all of the patterns of thought, emotions, and other mental traits that cause us to do and say things in particular ways.

❖ **Phonology**

The study of phonemes, or sounds, of language.

❖ **Physical anthropology**

The study of the non-cultural, or biological, aspects of humans and near humans. Physical anthropologists are usually involved in one of three different kinds of research: 1) non-human primate studies (usually in the wild), 2) recovering the fossil record of human evolution, and 3) studying human biological diversity, inheritance patterns, and non-cultural means of adapting to environmental stresses. Physical anthropology is also referred to as biological anthropology.

❖ **Plantation agriculture**

Large, labor-intensive farms that mostly produce fruit, sugar, fiber, or vegetable oil products for the international market. The laborers usually work for very low wages that keep them in poverty. Many of the plantations of Indonesia, the Philippines, Central America, the Caribbean, and West Africa are owned by multinational corporations such as Dole and the National Fruit Company. The net effect of this form of agriculture generally has been the flow of wealth from poor nations in the Southern Hemisphere to rich ones in the Northern Hemisphere.

❖ **Political symbol**

An idea or physical thing that is used by politicians as a tool for focusing the attention and emotions of people. It can be something as simple as the phrase "a chicken in every pot and a car in very garage" which was used by Herbert Hoover in his 1928 U.S. presidential election. It can be a call

for change such as the replacement of a king with a legislature or conversion of "non-believers" to the "true-religion." National flags are often powerful political symbols.

❖ **Politics**

Competition for power over people and things.

❖ **Polyandry**

The marriage of one woman to several men at the same time. This is a rare type of polygamy. It usually takes the form of "fraternal polyandry", which is brothers sharing the same wife.

❖ **Polygamy**

The generic term for marriage to more than one spouse at the same time. It occurs as polygyny or, more rarely, polyandry.

❖ **Polygyny**

The marriage of one man to several women at the same time. This is the most common form of polygamy. It often takes the form of "sororal polygyny", which is two or more sisters married to the same man.

❖ **Prejudice**

The act of judging someone or some thing before the facts is known. Assuming that someone of a specific ethnic group or "race" will act in a particular way is an example of pre-judging them. When people from different groups have little or no contact with each other, they are likely to hold prejudicial views about each other and to act upon them. If the prejudicial views are inaccurate, they can be obstacles to productive dialog and understanding.

❖ **Priest**

A religious leader who is part of an organized religion. Different religions have different terms for these individuals--they may be known as rabbis, ministers, mullahs, Imams, or other terms. They are the keepers of the sacred law and tradition. They are found mostly in large-scale societies. A female priests is often referred to as a priestess.

❖ **Race**

A biological subspecies, or variety, that consists of a more or less distinct population with anatomical traits that distinguish it clearly from other races. The human "races" commonly assumed to exist are mostly socio-cultural creations rather than biological realities. They are ethnic groups that are defined on the basis of both physical and cultural characteristics.

❖ **Racialism**

A relatively benign form of using "racial" distinctions, such as skin color and facial characteristics, for reference purposes. An example of racialism is identifying an accident victim as "an elderly

Asian male." In America, "racial" traits are commonly used along with age and gender distinctions when referring to people who we do not know personally.

- **Racism**

Harmful prejudice, discrimination, and/or persecution based on presumed ethnic/racial differences. An example of racism is not hiring someone for a job because of his or her skin color. Similarly, giving someone a preference in hiring due to skin color can be racism if people with other skin colors are disadvantaged by this act.

- **Random sample**

A probability sample in which people are selected on a totally random, unbiased basis. This can be accomplished by assigning a number to everyone in a community and then letting a computer or hand calculator generate a series of random numbers. If a 10% sample is needed, then the first 10% of the random numbers will indicate who will be the focus of the research. This sampling approach is reasonable for ethnographic research only when there does not seem to be much difference between the people in the population. Since this is rarely the case, random sampling is not often used for ethnographic research.

- **Reciprocity (or reciprocal exchange)**

A relationship between people that involves a mutual exchange of gifts of goods, services, or favors. Inherent in reciprocal gift giving is the obligation to return a gift in a culturally appropriate manner. Failure to do so is likely to end the reciprocal relationship. Reciprocity requires adequacy of response but not necessarily mathematical equality. Reciprocity is a common way of creating and continuing bonds between people.

- **Redistribution (or redistributive exchange)**

An economic exchange intended to distribute a society's wealth in a different way than exists at present. In the Western World, charity and progressive income tax systems are examples of redistributive exchanges. Progressive income taxes are intended to make people with greater wealth give at higher rates than those at the bottom of the economic ladder. Some of the tax money is then allocated to help the poorer members of society.

- **Rituals**

Stylized and usually repetitive acts that take place at a set time and location. They almost always involve the use of symbolic objects, words, and actions. For example, going to church on Sunday is a common religious ritual for Christians around the world.

- **Role**

The part a society expects an individual to play in a given status (e.g., child, wife, mother, aunt, grandmother). Social group membership gives us a set of role tags to allow people to know what to expect from each other.

- **Sapir-Whorf hypothesis**

The early 20th century idea of Edward Sapir and Benjamin Whorf that language predetermines what we see in the world around us. In other words, language acts like a polarizing lens on a camera in filtering reality--we see the real world only in the terms and categories of our language. This hypothesis was objectively tested by anthropologists in the 1960's. That research indicated that Sapir and Whorf went too far. It is now clear that the terminology used by a culture primarily reflects that culture's interests and concerns. All normal humans share similar sense perceptions due to the fact that their sense organs are essentially the same. Therefore, they can understand and perceive the categories of reality of another culture, if they are explained.

- **Scientific method**

The method of learning what is unknown in the natural world by formulating an hypothesis to explain observable or measurable facts and then collecting data through experiments and further observation to answer research questions based on the hypothesis. If the results of the tests support the hypothesis, it may become a theory. If the tests do not support the hypothesis, new hypotheses are developed and tested. The scientific method is the objective method by which old assumptions are challenged and scientific knowledge grows.

- **Secular**

Relating to worldly rather than religious things.

- **Sexism**

Discrimination based on gender. An example of sexism is excluding people from promotion to executive positions in a corporation due to their gender.

- **Shifting agriculture**

The horticultural practice of shifting from one field to another when crop production drops due to the inevitable depletion of soil nutrients. Shifting agriculture is also referred to as "swidden cultivation".

- **Siblings**

Brothers or sisters.

- **Slash and burn**

The method used by horticulturalists to clear fields of heavy vegetation in preparation for planting new crops. Brush and small trees are cut down and allowed to dry out in place. They are then burned. This simultaneously clears the field of all but large trees and adds ash to the soil surface. The ash acts as a fertilizer. No other fertilizer is applied to the field. As a result, soil productivity lasts only for a few years. Subsequently, horticulturalists practice shifting agriculture.

- **Small-scale farming**

Farming using horticultural techniques.

- **Small-scale society**

Generally a society of a few dozen to several thousand people who live by foraging wild foods, herding domesticated animals, or non-intensive horticulture on the band or village level. Such societies lack cities as well as complex economies and governments. Kinship relationships are usually highly important in comparison to large-scale societies.

❖ **Social anthropology**

See cultural anthropology.

❖ **Social dialect**

A dialect spoken by a speech community that is socially isolated from others. Social dialects are mostly based on class, ethnicity, gender, age, or particular social situations. The upper class English "public school" way of talking is an example of a social dialect.

❖ **Socialization**

The general process of acquiring culture as you grows up in a society. During socialization, children learn the language of the culture as well as the roles they are to play in life. In addition, they learn about the occupational roles that their society allows them. They also learn and usually adopt their culture's norms through the socialization process.

❖ **Society**

A group of interacting organisms. In the case of humans, societies are groups of people who directly or indirectly interact with each other. People in human societies also generally perceive that their society is distinct from other societies in terms of shared traditions and expectations.

❖ **Specialized foraging**

A foraging subsistence pattern in which a limited number of species are hunted or gathered. Aquatic and equestrian foragers usually are specialized in their food quest. Specialized foraging can be highly productive but is risky in environments that experience periodic droughts or other significant environmental changes that affect the food supply.

❖ **Speech**

A broad term referring to patterned verbal behavior.

❖ **State**

The level of political integration in which a society has a permanent, highly centralized political organization with an elite social class of rulers at the top. The bulk of the people are at the bottom of the pyramid of power. Between them and the rulers is a bureaucracy of officials who run the state on a daily basis. States with hereditary rulers first appeared 4000-5000 years ago in intensive agricultural societies of 10's to 100's of thousands of people. These were the ancient civilizations of Egypt, Mesopotamia (ancient Iraq), India, China, Mesoamerica, and the Andean mountain region of Western South America. Modern nations also have state levels of political organization, but rulers are generally elected now.

❖ **Status**

The relative social position of an individual. For instance, student, teacher, child, and parent are easily identifiable statuses in most cultures. Each of us has a number of different statuses. We usually acquire new ones and lose old ones as we go through life.

❖ **Stereotype**

A fixed notion or conception of people based on their group identity. For instance, assuming that a particular Chinese businessman is going to be greedy and dishonest because you believe that all Chinese businessmen are. Stereotyping is often at the base of prejudice and discrimination resulting from it.

❖ **Stratified sample**

A probability sample in which people are selected because they come from distinct sub-groups within the society. This approach may be used by ethnographers if the information that is being sought is not specialized knowledge such as the esoteric activities of a secret organization with restricted membership.

❖ **Sub arctic**

The area surrounding the arctic circle. In the Western Hemisphere, this includes the northern regions of Alaska and Canada. Subarctic also refers to the cold climates of these regions. Most subarctic regions are tundra.

❖ **Subculture**

A regional, social, or ethnic group that is distinguishable from other groups in a society. Members of a subculture often share a common identity, food tradition, dialect or language, and other cultural traits that come from their common ancestral background and experience. Subcultures are most likely to exist in complex, diverse societies, such as the U.S. and Canada, in which people have come from many different parts of the world.

❖ **Subsistence pattern**

The methods a society uses to obtain its food and other necessities (e.g., foraging, pastoralism, horticulture, and intensive agriculture). The term "subsistence pattern" is often used interchangeably with subsistence base.

❖ **Sudanese naming system**

A kin naming system in which kinsmen are not lumped together under the same terms of reference. Each category of relative is given a distinct term based on genealogical distance from ego and the side of the family. Also referred to as the "descriptive kin naming system."

❖ **Symbol**

A sound or thing which has meaning given to it by the user. Human languages are systems of symbols.

❖ **Theory**

A set of facts or principles that explain phenomena in the natural world. For instance the heliocentric theory in astronomy proposes that the sun is at the center of our solar system and that the earth and other planets revolve around it.

❖ **Third world**

Societies those are underdeveloped.

❖ **Totem**

A mythical clan founding ancestor. Totem origins are so far back in time that they are often believed to be non-human. Totems are used as symbols of clans. When they are believed to be particular kinds of animals or plants, killing or eating them is usually not allowed. Totems are also referred to as "totemic

❖ **Tribalism**

A profound loyalty to one's tribe, ethnic group, or nation and a rejection of others. Those who promote tribalism generally believe that globalism is a threat that must be overcome. A pattern of establishing ethnically "pure" nations through aggressive "ethnic cleansing" occurred in the former Yugoslavia during the 1990's. Similar attempts to carve out tribal based nations have occurred in the former republics of the Soviet Union and in a number of African nations. Tribalism is a counter force to globalization.

❖ **Tribe**

The level of political integration in which a society uses pantribal associations in order to provide unity and common interest. Tribes are more complex than bands due largely to the fact that they have more people and this new integrating mechanism that helps to prevent the disintegration of society. Tribes often have a headman who must lead through his powers of persuasion rather than clear authority to enforce his decisions. Tribes have been common among horticultural, pastoral, equestrian foraging, and rich aquatic foraging societies.

❖ **Tundra**

Treeless regions with permanently frozen soil. Tundra environments are found in the subarctic regions of the world and in some high mountains.

❖ **Underdeveloped nation**

A nation or society in which most of the people are persistently poor due to the way they are integrated into the world economic system. They usually provide cheap raw materials and labor for the rich, developed nations and purchase their manufactured goods at high prices. The economies of underdeveloped societies are largely dependent on the richer nations. Bangladesh and Guatemala are examples of underdeveloped nations. They are also referred to as "third world" or "developing" nations.

❖ **Undeveloped nation**

A largely isolated nation or society that has a low technological level but is economically self-reliant. They are not participants in the world economic system. Such societies mainly consist of indigenous peoples who have subsistence economies. By definition, undeveloped nations are not underdeveloped. Tibet and Afghanistan up until the 1950's are examples of undeveloped nations.

- **Unilineage**

A multi-generational group of relatives who are related by unilineal descent. Unlike clans, phratries, and moieties, members of unilineages usually know the precise genealogical link to the founder. Unilineages usually consist of a number of related nuclear families. See also matrilineage and patrilineage.

- **Unilineal descent**

Tracing kinship only through a single line of ancestors, male or female--that is, descent links are traced only through ancestors of one gender. See also matrilineal, patrilineal, and cognatic descent.

- **Virilocal residence**

The residence pattern in which a woman moves into her husband's home. If it is with his father instead, the residence pattern is called patrilocal.

- **Warfare**

Organized, large-scale combat usually between clearly recognizable armies. A significant portion of a population takes part in combats or support activities, often for years. Soldiers are trained and equipped for combat. Warfare is a larger scale; more organized and sustained form of fighting than feuding and raiding.

- **Western cultures**

European cultures and cultures derived from Europe, such as the United States and Canada. Western societies predominantly speak a European language and maintain European-like economic, political, legal, and educational systems. These societies have been the principle sources of pressure towards globalization in the late 20th century. The western cultures are also referred to as the "western world."

- **World-view**

The complex of motivations, perceptions, and beliefs that we internalize and that strongly affect how we interact with other people and things in nature. World-view is a set of feelings and basic attitudes about the world rather than clearly formulated opinions about it. These feelings and attitudes are mostly learned early in life and are not readily changed later. They have a determinate influence on our observable behavior, both verbal and non-verbal.

For Files and Groups of Maha Malik:

https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029VaLvft01XquQQ7sIB12s

Maha Malik's Compilation